

Philipp Hilbert. *Payments product owner who has shipped the full stack from P2P fintech to POS.*

Positioning, ten years owning regulated payment and fintech products end-to-end, now bringing that depth to CNTXT AI's payments roadmap in Dubai.

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Dear Hiring Team at CNTXT AI,

I am applying for the Product Manager / Product Owner, Payments role. My interest is direct: I founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P group-payment product that was acquired by Sparkasse and operated inside the girocard ecosystem. I built it from zero, owned the payment gateway integrations, the settlement and reconciliation logic, the refund and failure paths, and the regulatory dialogue with banking partners. That is the core vocabulary of this role, and it is where I have the deepest hands-on scar tissue.

Beyond Kvitt, I have thirteen years of end-to-end product ownership across regulated industries. At Scheidt & Bachmann I owned the integration of POS and forecourt payment systems in a SAFE environment. At EMIL Group I shipped an insurance B2B SaaS Claims Center from concept to production, cutting time-to-market for a new product line from months to under a week. At Rohde & Schwarz I introduced GitOps delivery that took platform rollout from days to thirty minutes, a pattern directly applicable to payment gateway configuration and hotfix deployment. The thread across these roles is the same: I take operational complexity, map it rigorously, and reduce it to something a lean cross-functional team can ship and maintain.

The job description names payment failures, settlement, reconciliation, and operational efficiency as central concerns. These are not abstract concepts to me. At Kvitt I debugged failed transactions at the network layer, rebuilt reconciliation logic when bank statements did not match internal ledgers, and designed the retry and fallback UX that kept the user experience intact when a payment processor was slow. I also handled the compliance and security requirements that come with operating inside a regulated payment ecosystem, a skill I carried into my later roles as Deputy IT Security Officer at Bundesagentur für Arbeit.

I am an AI-native practitioner. I use Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, and Lovable daily, not as productivity theatre but as the actual toolchain through which I generate specs, enumerate edge cases, prototype flows, and accelerate the gap between discovery and engineering handoff. In a fast-moving AI/FinTech environment this matters: I do not wait for a designer or a developer to make a hypothesis testable.

Dubai is a genuine target for me, not a compromise. I am actively seeking to relocate to the UAE and am fully open to on-site work there. I can be available on four weeks' notice. I would welcome a conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
